

These three are not the same kind of choice. Lake Oswego and Beaverton are separate cities with their own school districts, budgets and character. Highland — also sold as Hyland Hills — is a wooded residential neighborhood inside Beaverton. Most buyers settle the city question first and the street question second, so the guide is ordered that way.

	Lake Oswego CITY	Beaverton CITY	Highland WITHIN BEAVERTON
COUNTY	Clackamas, with parts in Multnomah and Washington	Washington	Washington
SCHOOL DISTRICT	Lake Oswego School District	Beaverton 48J, with parts in Hillsboro and Portland districts	Beaverton 48J
POPULATION	About 40,700	About 97,500 — seventh largest in Oregon	Counted within Beaverton
DISTANCE	Roughly 7 miles south of Portland	Roughly 7 miles west of Portland	Roughly 10 miles west of downtown Portland
SETTING	Lakeside and wooded, residential throughout	A working city and regional employment center	Douglas fir cover, quiet and set back from the arterials
HOUSING	Ranges from lakefront estates to wooded contemporary	Broad mix, from apartments to established single-family	Mid-century modern, ranch and split-level, largely single-story
GETTING AROUND	Car and bus; no light rail	Seven MAX stations on two lines; WES commuter rail	Car; Cedar Hills Crossing about two miles north
KNOWN FOR	Oswego Lake, and a 19th-century iron industry past	Nike's global headquarters and the Silicon Forest	Fir Grove and Channing Heights parks; Hyland Forest Park nearby

\$884,631

LAKE OSWEGO · TYPICAL HOME VALUE

Zillow home value index, up 1.4% year on year, 31 August 2026.

\$630,000

BEAVERTON · MEDIAN SALE PRICE

Redfin, up 14.5% year on year, 37 days on market, August 2026.

Read those two figures separately, not against each other. They come from different providers and measure different things — a modelled value index against an actual median of closed sales. The gap between the cities is real, but these numbers do not size it. Ask for a like-for-like analysis before drawing a conclusion from either.

BEFORE YOU ASSUME LAKE ACCESS

A Lake Oswego address does not by itself come with the right to use Oswego Lake. Access runs with specific easements attached to particular properties and neighborhood associations, and the question of public access has been through the Oregon courts more than once in recent years.

It is one of the most common misunderstandings among buyers new to the city, and it materially affects value. Confirm what a specific property actually conveys before making an offer on the strength of the lake.



CLACKAMAS COUNTY · CITY

Lake Oswego

Seven miles south of Portland, built around a 405-acre lake the Clackamas people called Waluga. The city was the hub of Oregon's iron industry in the late 1800s before becoming residential. Its own school district runs two high schools, Lake Oswego and Lakeridge, and the downtown along A Avenue carries an unusually complete set of shops and restaurants for a city of 40,000.

Consider it if you want a self-contained small city with its own district, and you are buying at the upper end of the metro.



WASHINGTON COUNTY · CITY

Beaverton

The seventh largest city in Oregon and the economic center of Washington County alongside Hillsboro. Nike's global headquarters sits here, employing around 6,000 people, with the school district itself the next largest employer. Seven MAX stations across two lines and the busiest transit center in the TriMet system make it the most connected of the three by a wide margin.

Consider it if the commute matters, or you want the widest range of housing types and prices on the westside.



BEAVERTON · NEIGHBORHOOD

Highland · Hyland Hills

A wooded pocket about ten miles west of downtown Portland, under tall Douglas firs that give it a quieter, more secluded feel than the arterials nearby would suggest. Housing is almost entirely single-family and mid-century — ranch and split-level, often single-story, with the large windows and courtyards of the period. Fir Grove and Channing Heights parks sit inside it, Hyland Forest Park just beyond.

Consider it if you want Beaverton's access and schools but trees and quiet on the street itself.



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